

OCS-029 — Constitutional Library

Status: Foundational

Authority: Constitutional

Depends on:

- OCS-000 through OCS-028
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Purpose

This specification defines the constitutional concept of the Library.

The Library is the constitutional memory through which Understanding becomes reusable.

A Library is not merely a collection of information.

A Library is a living constitutional structure that preserves Questions, Evidence, Explanations, Discoveries, and their relationships across generations.

Every Constitutional Place MAY maintain one or more Libraries.

The Constitutional Corpus is itself the highest constitutional Library.

1. Definition

A Constitutional Library is an organized constitutional structure whose purpose is to preserve and make constitutional understanding continuously discoverable.

A Library SHALL preserve:

Identity

Purpose

History

Relationships

Meaning

Continuity

A Library SHALL remain reconstructable independently of its implementation.

2. Constitutional Purpose

The constitutional purpose of a Library is to make previous understanding available for future understanding.

A Library SHALL support:

Discovery

Learning

Reference

Comparison

Reconstruction

Explanation

Preservation

The Library SHALL reduce repeated loss of understanding.

3. Constitutional Membership

A Library MAY contain:

Questions

Observations

Evidence

Experiments

Explanations

Discoveries

Participants

Places

Contributions

Canonical Definitions

Specifications

Historical Records

Every member SHALL preserve constitutional identity.

Membership SHALL remain historically attributable.

4. Constitutional Organization

The Library SHALL organize constitutional constructs through explicit relationships.

Organization MAY include:

Semantic relationships

Historical relationships

Methodological relationships

Dependency relationships

Topical relationships

No organizational structure SHALL redefine constitutional meaning.

5. Constitutional Discovery

The Library SHALL support constitutional discovery.

Discovery SHALL preserve:

Historical context

Semantic relationships

Evidence lineage

Canonical references

Discovery SHALL improve accessibility.

It SHALL NOT modify constitutional meaning.

6. Constitutional Preservation

The Library SHALL preserve:

Current understanding

Superseded understanding

Rejected explanations

Failed experiments

Historical uncertainty

Competing interpretations

Nothing constitutionally valuable SHALL disappear merely because it is no longer preferred.

7. Constitutional Provenance

Every Library entry SHALL expose its provenance.

Provenance SHALL preserve:

Origin

History

Dependencies

Revision lineage

Contributing Participants

Associated Places

Provenance SHALL remain reconstructable.

8. Constitutional Navigation

Every Library SHALL support navigation through constitutional relationships.

Navigation SHALL allow independent investigators to move through:

Questions

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Experiments

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Evidence

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Explanations

↓

Understanding

↓

Decisions

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Actions

Navigation SHALL preserve constitutional continuity.

9. Constitutional Curation

Libraries MAY be curated.

Curation SHALL organize.

Curation SHALL NOT redefine constitutional meaning.

Curatorial decisions SHALL remain historically attributable.

Alternative curations MAY coexist.

10. Constitutional Federation

Independent Libraries MAY federate.

Federation SHALL preserve:

Local sovereignty

Independent history

Canonical compatibility

Relationship integrity

Federation SHALL expand discoverability.

It SHALL NOT erase local organization.

11. Constitutional Memory

The Library SHALL preserve constitutional memory beyond the lifetime of individual Participants.

Memory SHALL remain:

Searchable

Traceable

Explainable

Historically attributable

Recoverable

The Library SHALL become the long-term memory of a Place.

12. Constitutional Growth

Growth SHALL improve:

Coverage

Connectivity

Explainability

Discoverability

Historical completeness

Growth SHALL NOT justify loss of continuity.

13. Constitutional Reconstruction

A Library SHALL be reconstructable using:

Its constitutional identity

Its preserved members

Its relationships

Its history

Its applicable specifications

Its canonical references

No implementation-specific knowledge SHALL be required.

14. Constitutional Library Test

A Constitutional Library satisfies this specification when an independent investigator can determine:

Why does this Library exist?

What understanding does it preserve?

How are its contents related?

How has it evolved?

What has been intentionally preserved?

How can future generations continue building upon it?

If any answer cannot be reconstructed,

the Library is constitutionally incomplete.

Conformance

An implementation conforms to this specification when every Constitutional Library preserves identity, meaning, relationships, historical continuity, and discoverability independently of implementation technology.

Constitutional Principle

Books preserve texts.

Archives preserve records.

Libraries preserve civilizations.

The Constitutional Library preserves understanding.

Its purpose is not merely to remember what was known.

Its purpose is to ensure that every generation begins from the deepest understanding achieved by those who came before, while remaining free to question, improve, and extend it.

End of Specification OCS-029